

The North Texas Starter Map (McKinney & Collin County)

This is a researched head start for Weeks 2–5, verified against live sources in August 2026. It is a **starting map, not the finished census** — Week 3’s job is to expand it, confirm what’s currently posted, and add the smaller shops no list ever captures. Openings and programs change; treat every entry as “verified recently, re-check before acting.”

The headline: you live in one of the best places in America to run this exact plan. A major defense electronics campus is *in McKinney*, the largest wire and cable plant in the country is *in McKinney*, and Texas Instruments is building a \$30 billion semiconductor campus 35 minutes up US-75 that needs thousands of technicians — with a community college pipeline built specifically to feed it.

Right in McKinney (no commute problem at all)

Company	What they do	Why it matters for this plan
Raytheon (RTX)	Major defense electronics campus — radar, microelectronics, a Consolidated Manufacturing Center	Hundreds of local openings at any given time, including Test Technician and Production roles; strong benefits and education assistance; note most roles require U.S. citizenship (clearance work)
Encore Wire / Prysmian	One of the largest single-campus wire & cable plants in the U.S., McKinney HQ	Production starts around \$17–20/hr with overtime at 1.5x and shift differential; machine operator and warehouse tech roles; a true Tech I → Tech II ladder
Dynacraft (a PACCAR company)	Truck parts manufacturing	Assembler/production entry roles inside a Fortune-500 truck maker’s supply chain
Simpson Strong-Tie	Structural connectors and building hardware manufacturing	Production and quality entry roles at a large national manufacturer
CoServ	Electric cooperative + gas utility, HQ in McKinney	Utility career ladders (meter tech, line apprentice, operations); utilities are education-benefit strongholds — check their current careers page
Broach Built Manufacturing	Contract manufacturer	Small-shop entry point — exactly the kind of place for the “self-made internship” pitch in Appendix B
Amazon (fulfillment)	Warehouse/logistics	Bridge option only — Career Choice education funding + internal maintenance-tech ladder (see Appendix C)

Company / site	Where	What it means for you
Texas Instruments — Sherman fab (SM1)	Sherman, ~35 min north on US-75	A \$30B, 3,000+-job semiconductor campus ramping up right now ; fabs hire manufacturing technicians with HS diploma/associate level training and TI has education assistance; this is the single biggest structural opportunity on this map
Grayson College	Denison/Sherman	Advanced-manufacturing and semiconductor-technician courses built in partnership with TI to feed the Sherman fab — a direct, designed pipeline from classroom to fab badge
L3Harris	Greenville, ~35–40 min east	~70-year-old aircraft ISR integration site; hires Aircraft Mechanics and Assembly Technicians; defense benefits + education assistance; citizenship typically required
Texas Instruments — RFAB	Richardson, ~25 min south	Same technician story as Sherman, closer, longer-established
Toyota Motor North America	Plano, ~20 min	North American HQ — more engineering-office than factory-floor, but internships and technical programs worth watching once she's enrolled
Ericsson & north-Dallas electronics	Plano/Richardson telecom corridor	Electronics test/assembler roles across the corridor's contract manufacturers
Oncor	Service territory covers the region	Texas's largest electric utility; line and substation apprenticeships, technician roles
Lockheed Martin / Bell	Fort Worth, ~1 hr+	The region's flagship aerospace employers — long commute, but worth knowing they anchor the west side of the metroplex (F-35 plant, helicopters)

The education picture (this is unusually good)

- **Collin College** (campuses in McKinney, Plano, Frisco, Wylie) — the obvious Week 5 starting point:
- A dedicated **Engineering Transfer** program (calculus/physics/intro engineering sequence built for transfer into BS Engineering programs)
- The **Academic Alliance** with **UT Dallas** and **Texas State**, including guaranteed-transfer pathways and co-enrollment — get the engineering course plan in writing from an advisor (acadalliance@collin.edu, 972-599-3167)
- The **Technical Campus in Allen** (~10 min away): advanced manufacturing, welding, HVAC, robotics — the credential-fast routes
- **UT Dallas** (Richardson, ~25 min) — the natural ABET-accredited transfer target for EE; commutable from home
- **Grayson College** (Sherman/Denison) — the TI semiconductor-technician pipeline; pairs perfectly with a Sherman fab job

- **UNT (Denton) and UT Arlington** — additional in-region ABET engineering schools if the UTD math changes

The electrician route, locally

IBEW Local 20 / North Texas Electrical Training Center (NTX JATC): applications accepted **year-round** (\$20 fee), apprentices start around **\$20.33/hr plus ~\$2.91/hr into insurance & retirement** with scheduled raises, and classroom work earns college credit through Dallas College. Local 20's office is in Grand Prairie (972-263-1122); training center info at ntejatc.org. For a McKinney EE-leaning kid who wants to earn from day one, this is the strongest no-college-first option in the region.

How to use this map in the program

- **Week 2:** search the exact technician titles from Appendix A against these company names on Indeed/LinkedIn.
- **Week 3:** this map seeds the company census — expand it (the McKinney Economic Development Corporation publishes a notable-employers list, and the US-75 corridor industrial parks are full of unlisted shops), then collect the 15 live openings.
- **Week 4:** verify current tuition/education benefits at Raytheon, TI, L3Harris, Prysmian, CoServ, and Oncor from their own careers pages.
- **Week 5:** book the Collin College engineering-transfer advising appointment and ask about the UT Dallas alliance in the same visit.
- **Week 7:** Raytheon McKinney and Prysmian employees are neighbors here — the family-network ask (“do we know anyone who works at Raytheon?”) will probably land on the first try.

Sources (retrieved August 2026)

- Raytheon McKinney openings: [Indeed](#), [ZipRecruiter](#)
- Encore Wire / Prysmian McKinney: [North Texas Job Fair profile](#), [ZipRecruiter](#)
- TI Sherman: [TI.com Sherman fabs](#), [Gov. Abbott announcement](#), [SMU/Texoma semiconductor-hub coverage](#), [Sherman EDCO](#)
- L3Harris Greenville: [careers.l3harris.com Greenville](#)
- Collin College: [Engineering Transfer](#), [Academic Alliance](#), [UTD Collin Alliance](#), [Technical Campus](#), [Texas State guaranteed transfer](#)
- IBEW Local 20 / NTX JATC: [ibew20.org apprenticeship](#), [ntejatc.org](#)
- McKinney employers: [McKinney EDC notable employers](#)
- Utilities: [Oncor careers](#), [CoServ](#)